Integration Execution and Synergy Realization Across acquisitions from Newport (2012–13) through Tribune (2019), Nexstar consistently reported that synergy targets were met or exceeded. The integration approach — pre-close station visits and market-level business planning — was described as a replicable playbook. For Newport, realized synergies exceeded the announced target by $2M. For Tribune, the synergy target was raised from $160M to $185M before the transaction closed. Management self-assessments are consistently positive and never qualified with negative results.	> "As it relates to the synergies, I think we had been public in the first Newport acquisition of identifying approximately $19 million of synergies. I'm happy to report that after our team has gone in and spent the time and done the additional work, and followed every line item down to the decimal point, that our actual realized synergies for the first Newport series of acquisitions will be closer to $21 million on an annualized basis. [...] There are some synergies related to the Inergize acquisition because we are running our operations in parallel for the first six months of this year, that won't be realized until the end of second quarter." Perry Sook, President and CEO [Mar 2013] > "By January 17, 2017, 478 days had passed from the time we made our first public offer to acquire Media General to the closing of the transaction. During this period, we've visited every Media General station and digital business location, a practice which has proven over our 20 years in the business, to ensure that we integrate quickly and deliver the financial results that meet and exceed your expectations." Perry A. Sook, Chairman, President & CEO [Feb 2017] > "Our success in rapidly integrating and realizing value from acquisitions has been proven time and again in transactions large and small. Our successful integrations are a result of the preparations we make leading up to the closing, including station visits, establishing business plans for each newly acquired entity and creating a comprehensive overall integration plan so that we are fast out of the gate to meet our operating and synergy expectations on or ahead of schedule. Reflecting the work done between announcing Tribune last December and our September closing, we raised our initial anticipated first year transaction operating synergies target to approximately $185 million from approximately $160 million originally." Perry A. Sook, Chairman, President & CEO [Nov 2019]
Deal Financing, Leverage, and Capital Structure Nexstar financed acquisitions through Term Loan B facilities, senior note issuances (8.875%, 6 7/8%, 6 1/8%, 5 5/8%), and operating cash flow. A stated leverage ceiling of 5.5x governed deal sizing, with a mid-3x target once integration was complete. Credit agreements allowed synergy-adjusted pro forma leverage, supporting the acquisition model. For Tribune, a $6.4B committed facility was secured, with divestiture proceeds from 21 stations reducing projected opening leverage from 5.3x to below 5x.	> "Reflecting the accretive structure of the recently completed and announced transactions and lower cost of capital, pro forma for the completion of the current station transactions remaining, our net leverage is expected to decrease to the mid-3 times range by the end of 2014." Perry Sook, President, CEO [Aug 2013] > "As it relates to our funding of the pending acquisition of Tribune Media, we intend to be opportunistic in tapping the markets and have a $6.4 billion committed financing facility initially provided by Bank of America Merrill Lynch, Crédit Suisse and Deutsche Bank to fund the transaction's cash consideration. Similar to our previous transaction, our intention to that is to have pro forma capital structure reflect a proper balance of fixed and floating debt and attractive weighted average cost of capital with prepayment and refinancing flexibility." Thomas E. Carter, Executive VP & CFO [Feb 2019] > "As mentioned — as Perry mentioned during the first and second quarter, we entered into 3 agreements to sell a total of 21 stations in 16 markets for an aggregate gross proceeds of $1.36 billion, and we intend to use the net proceeds from the divestitures to fund the Tribune acquisition and to reduce debt. At closing, which is anticipated in 3Q of '19, we expect our net leverage level will approximate 5.1x compared to our prior estimate of 5.3x." Thomas E. Carter, Executive VP & CFO [May 2019]